tweeting furiously with vim, vigour and venom would be the only familiar hallmark of Rahul Gandhi's political riposte to every issue he chooses to take up.

Mr Ram Sewak Sharma, the bureaucrat in charge of several major digital initiatives over the years such as Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and Aadhaar, had last month sought time to see the prime minister. Today, on 30 June, he was to finally meet with the PM to discuss how digitization could help India in its battle against the virus. He had retired from service several years ago but was brought back to head the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI). A fine IAS officer with an educational background from University of California and subsequent doctorate from IIT-Delhi, he was one of India's go-to men for his expertise in data digitization and security. He had been planning the presentation he was about to make to the prime minister for months. There was no doubt in his mind that if a billion people had to be vaccinated in four to six months, then a 'digital vaccination certificate' would be required which could be used to allow friction-free movement as the country opened up. Ahead of time, he wrote in the first slide of his Power Point presentation: high digital coordination would be needed to achieve scale, save cost, increase economic value and avoid social issues.

He included his learning and experiences from Aadhaar in which he noted that within a year of launch, 1,500 empanelled agencies, 40,000 enrolment stations, 2 lakh trained operators and 15 lakh enrolments were all coordinated by the common digital platform put in place. In order to make the vaccination project a success, the government should be planning to achieve over a crore vaccinations per day, he opined. He proceeded to present a bunch of high-level ideas which included details on empanelment, necessary training, certification of providers and price discovery for vaccinating each person. He added ways to make payment at these empanelled locations and suggested pre-paid payment vouchers. He insisted that a large number of locations such as camps at community centres, mobile vans and so on must be activated instead of a few central places so as to avoid crowding and panic. He also suggested creating a National Testing and Vaccination Platform to orchestrate this entire effort. He added that other rules required in the domain would have to be factored in ahead of time: some people may not need to be vaccinated, so perhaps we should consider proving them with an 'Immunity certificate'; some people may not